

General Notes to Keep in Mind:

You are a participant in another study, not another researcher. We want the participant to feel as though they are having a peer-to-peer interaction while in VR, and not be biased in how they react to you by thinking of you as a researcher.

In your VR experience, you will be waiting for the participant to come over to a designated area that you and the other confederate will be in. Once the participant arrives, they will give you a tour. Feel free to talk with each other before the participant arrives to give you your tour, because the participant will already be told you are there (there is no need to “hide” or pretend you aren’t there).

Notes on the places you’ll wait and guidelines for how to behave around the participant are included below.

Places to Wait in Each Park:

Park 1:

1. The wooden dock by the river.
 - a. This is located by the river that cuts through the center of the park.
 - b. You can stand on the dock or wander around it in the river, on the boat, or the grassy space right by it, but don’t wander far.

Park 2:

1. The picnic tables.
 - a. These are a set of four tables located by a red-roofed gazebo.
 - b. You can wander around the entire grassy area that the picnic tables are on, or enter the nearby gazebo, but don’t wander far.

How to Speak Around the Participant:

1. Be polite and friendly.
2. Act as though you have never been in the park before.
 - a. Part of your instructions above is to not wander from the designated area you’re waiting in. We want the participant to think that you haven’t seen the rest of the park and only know about the area you’re currently in. So we don’t want you to talk as though you’ve seen the park already, or be wandering around chatting together and have them hear your voice in other parts of the park.
3. Be inquisitive and ask many questions on the tour.

- a. You don't want to ask so many questions that you are constantly talking over them, but you want to ask questions so that the participant is having a social experience, while also needing to give visual information about the park.
 - b. You can ask questions about the participants themselves, the park, or the guide. You can try to aim for at least five questions in each category, but this isn't a hard rule. Simply ask questions based on the flow of the conversation.
- 4. Feel free to share simple personal information, such as your name or occupation.
 - a. Participants may also share this information with you, though others may be much more private. It depends on the participant. Share what you feel comfortable sharing, or feel free to make up a name and background if you would rather do that.
- 5. If you are asked about what you are doing in the VR park, state that you're a participant in another study.
 - a. This is for the reasons stated above. We do not want to bias participants into treating you differently or viewing the conversation differently because they are interacting with researchers.
- 6. If you are asked about the study you are doing, say that you're supposed to get practice being in social VR before you do your study task, but you haven't been told what the task is yet.
 - a. The study you are doing is also on social VR, but is focused more on understanding and improving social interactions between people in VR. So far, this is all you know about the study. You'll be told more after you complete your initial social experiences in VR.

How to Move Around the Participant:

- 1. Try to stay close to the participant as they move around during the tour.
 - a. In the past study, participants often teleported accidentally or shot off into random places, especially if they were having issues with the VR controls and couldn't tell when they had pressed the teleportation trigger or where they pointed to teleport. You may have to hurry to keep up with them or teleport after them.
- 2. If you lose sight of the participant, listen for them or the guide and go to them.
 - a. You should be able to hear their voices spatialized to where they're coming from in the scene. You can use this to find them again.
 - b. Something else that is helpful if you have no idea of where they are is teleporting around the perimeter of the park or various places spread out in different directions around the park and listening for where the voice might be coming from.
 - c. Sometimes, participants have accidentally teleported beyond the boundaries of the park. In our previous study, the human guide could actively tell them to grab on and take them back in, but the AI guide will not be able to suggest such action. If the participant doesn't ask the guide to take them back or find another way back in, we may have to restart the scene in extreme cases.

3. Use natural body language and gestures.
 - a. Try to gesture with your hands and body as you would communicate in real life.
Most people in social VR applications use a lot of body language, and we would like to imitate social VR interactions as much as possible in the interactions the participant has with you.

Example Questions to Ask the Participant:

In the first park:

Park:

- How big is the park?
- Is this park pretty popular?
- What kinds of things can we do in the park?

Participant:

- What other kinds of virtual environments have you been in?
- Is this your first time giving a virtual tour?

Guide: [Since this is the first time meeting the guide, questions should be about who/what it is]

[Robot]

- Is there a real human behind the robot?
- Does the robot have a name?

[Dog]

- What's your dog's name?
 - What type of dog is it?
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In the second park:

Park:

- How big is the park?
- Is this park pretty popular?
- What kinds of things can we do in the park?

Participant:

- Do you like this park better than the last one?
- Do you like going to parks in real life?

Guide: [Since this is the second time meeting the guide, questions should be about how it has changed + curious questions about the guide]

[Robot]

- Is this guide better than the last one?
- Can I try talking to it?
- Did you pick how the robot looks?

[Dog]

- Is this guide better than the last one?
- Can I try talking to it?
- Did you pick what type of dog it is?